

G1-P01

ILLUSTRATED GLOSSARY OF CROCHET STITCHES

— Essential techniques, symbols, and step-by-step charts —



Illustrated Tutorial Manual

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INTRODUCTION

How This Program Works

Four weekends, four finished projects, one beautifully decorated home

This program is designed for one simple goal: by the end of four weekends, you will have four real, finished crochet pieces displayed in your home — not in a drawer, not "almost done," but placed and looking beautiful.

The Structure

Each weekend is one self-contained project. They are ordered by difficulty and size, so your skills build naturally:

WEEKEND	PROJECT	SKILL LEVEL	TIME NEEDED	WHERE IT GOES
1	Coaster set (6 pieces)	Beginner	4–5 hours	Coffee table / kitchen counter
2	Placemats (2 pieces)	Beginner	5–6 hours	Dining or kitchen table
3	Cushion cover (1 piece)	Intermediate	5–6 hours	Living room sofa
4	Throw blanket (1 piece)	Intermediate	6–8 hours	Sofa or bed

Total time commitment: approximately 20–25 hours across four weekends (4–6 hours per weekend). You can split each weekend across Saturday and Sunday, or tackle it in one focused day.

What You Will Have at the End

After four weekends, you will own:

- 6 coasters for your coffee table or kitchen
- 2 placemats for your dining table
- 1 cushion cover for your living room
- 1 small throw blanket (100×130cm) for your sofa or bed

That is **10 handmade items** in four weekends — enough to visibly transform your living space.

Master Materials List

Buy everything at once so you are never waiting for supplies mid-weekend.

MATERIAL	QUANTITY	FOR WHICH WEEKEND(S)	APPROX. COST
Worsted weight cotton yarn — Color A (main)	5 skeins (100g each)	Weekends 1, 2	\$20–25
Worsted weight cotton yarn — Color B (accent)	1 skein (100g)	Weekends 1, 2	\$4–5
Worsted weight acrylic/cotton blend — Color C (main)	4 skeins (100g each)	Weekend 3	\$16–20
Bulky weight acrylic or wool-blend — Color D (main)	6 skeins (100g each)	Weekend 4	\$30–36
Crochet hook — 5.0mm	1	Weekends 1, 2, 3	\$3–5
Crochet hook — 6.5mm	1	Weekend 4	\$3–5
Tapestry needle (blunt, large-eye)	2	All weekends	\$2–3
Stitch markers	10	All weekends	\$3–4
Measuring tape	1	All weekends	\$1–2
Scissors	1 pair	All weekends	You have these
Cushion insert 45×45cm	1	Weekend 3	\$8–12
Blocking mat + pins (optional)	1 set	Weekends 1, 4	\$10–15

Total estimated cost: \$100–132 for all four weekends. Choose one coordinating color family (e.g., sage green + cream, dusty blue + white, terracotta + natural) so all the pieces look cohesive in your home.

Before You Start — Preparation Checklist

- ☐ All materials purchased (see master list above)
- ☐ A comfortable, well-lit workspace set up (near a window if possible)
- ☐ Color palette chosen (2–3 coordinating colors)
- ☐ Basic crochet knowledge: chain (ch), slip stitch (sl st), single crochet (sc), half double crochet (hdc), double crochet (dc)
- ☐ If you are new to crochet: practice chaining and single crochet for 30 minutes before Weekend 1
- ☐ Weekend 1 scheduled on your calendar (block Saturday 9am–1pm + Sunday 10am–12pm)

Weekend 1: Quick Wins — Coaster Set

Difficulty: Beginner | Time: 4–5 hours | Makes: 6 round coasters (10cm diameter)

SATURDAY

Practice swatch, complete 3–4 coasters

SUNDAY

Finish set of 6, block and style

Why Start Here

Coasters are the perfect first project. They are small (you finish one in 30–40 minutes), they use only basic stitches, and the satisfaction of completing a tangible item quickly builds momentum for the weekends ahead. If you make a mistake, you have only lost 20 minutes — not 20 hours.

Materials for This Weekend

- 1 skein worsted cotton — Color A
- 1 skein worsted cotton — Color B (optional accent border)
- 5.0mm hook
- Tapestry needle, scissors, stitch marker

Saturday Morning: Practice Swatch

Before diving in, make a quick practice swatch. Chain 15, work 5 rows of single crochet. Check your tension: if the fabric feels stiff and hard to push the hook through, loosen up. If it feels floppy with visible gaps between stitches, tighten up. Your gauge for these coasters should be approximately **4 sc = 2cm**. Adjust hook size up or down if needed.

Simple Round Coaster Pattern

Finished size: approximately 10cm (4") diameter.

Gauge: Rounds 1–2 = 4cm diameter with 5.0mm hook and worsted cotton.

Abbreviations: ch = chain, sl st = slip stitch, sc = single crochet, inc = 2 sc in same stitch.

INSTRUCTIONS

Round 1: Make a magic ring. Ch 1 (does not count as a stitch), work 6 sc into the ring. Sl st to the first sc to join. Pull the ring tail tight. (6 sts)

Round 2: Ch 1, inc in every stitch around. Sl st to join. (12 sts)

Round 3: Ch 1, *sc 1, inc* — repeat around. Sl st to join. (18 sts)

Round 4: Ch 1, *sc 2, inc* — repeat around. Sl st to join. (24 sts)

Round 5: Ch 1, *sc 3, inc* — repeat around. Sl st to join. (30 sts)

Round 6: Ch 1, *sc 4, inc* — repeat around. Sl st to join. (36 sts)

Round 7 (border): Switch to Color B if desired. Ch 1, sc in every stitch around. Sl st to join. Fasten off. (36 sts)

Weave in all ends with your tapestry needle. Weave at least 3cm in one direction, then reverse and weave 3cm back for a secure finish.

Saturday Afternoon: Build the Set

Now that you have your first coaster done, the pattern is memorized. Your second coaster will take half the time. Aim to complete 3–4 coasters by end of Saturday. Take 5-minute breaks between coasters to stretch your hands.

Sunday: Finish & Block

Complete the remaining coasters to reach 6. Then block them all at once:

1. Fill a basin with cool water and a drop of gentle soap. Submerge all 6 coasters for 15 minutes.
2. Gently squeeze out water (do not wring). Roll each coaster in a towel to remove excess moisture.
3. Pin each coaster flat on your blocking mat (or a clean towel on a flat surface). Use pins to shape them into even circles.
4. Let dry completely (4–8 hours depending on humidity).

Milestone Moment

You just made your first complete set of home decor. Stack them on your coffee table, fan them out, or place one at each family member's seat. You made these. With your hands. That is not a small thing.

Weekend 1 Completion Checklist

- ☐ Practice swatch completed and gauge checked
- ☐ 6 coasters crocheted with ends woven in
- ☐ All coasters blocked and dried
- ☐ Coasters placed in their spot (coffee table, kitchen counter, or nightstand)
- ☐ Leftover yarn wound neatly and stored for future repairs

Weekend 2: The Kitchen Table — Placemats

Difficulty: Beginner | Time: 5–6 hours | Makes: 2 rectangular placemats (33×48cm)

SATURDAY

Start and complete the first placemat

SUNDAY

Complete the second placemat, block both

Building on Weekend 1

You already know sc and working in rounds. This weekend you work in rows (back and forth) and learn the waffle stitch, which creates a beautiful textured grid that is both decorative and highly functional — the raised texture grips plates and prevents sliding.

Materials for This Weekend

- 2–3 skeins worsted cotton — Color A (each placemat uses about 90g)
- 5.0mm hook
- Tapestry needle, scissors

Waffle Stitch Placemat Pattern

Finished size: approximately 33×48cm (13×19").

Gauge: 14 stitches × 8 rows = 10cm in waffle stitch with 5.0mm hook and worsted cotton.

Additional abbreviations: dc = double crochet, fpdc = front post double crochet, bpdc = back post double crochet.

FOUNDATION

Ch 68. (This gives you a width of approximately 48cm. Adjust in multiples of 3 + 2 if needed.)

INSTRUCTIONS

Row 1 (setup): Dc in 4th ch from hook (the skipped 3 ch count as 1 dc), dc in each ch across. Turn. (*66 dc*)

Row 2: Ch 3 (counts as dc), *fpdc around next st, fpdc around next st, bpdc around next st* — repeat across, ending with dc in the top of the turning chain. Turn.

Row 3: Ch 3 (counts as dc), *bpdc around next st, bpdc around next st, fpdc around next st* — repeat across, ending with dc in the top of the turning chain. Turn.

Repeat Rows 2–3 until the placemat measures 33cm (approximately 26 rows total). End after a Row 3.

BORDER

Do not turn. Work 1 round of sc evenly around the entire rectangle: sc in each stitch across the top, 3 sc in the corner, sc evenly down the side (approximately 2 sc per row-end), 3 sc in the corner, sc across the bottom (1 per foundation chain), 3 sc in the corner, sc up the other side, 3 sc in the last corner. Sl st to join. Fasten off.

Weave in all ends.

Saturday: First Placemat

The waffle stitch has a rhythm: after 4–5 rows, you will stop looking at the pattern and start feeling the raised posts under your hook. The first placemat takes about 2.5–3 hours. Take a break halfway to stretch your wrists.

Sunday: Second Placemat & Blocking

Your second placemat will go faster — the stitch is now muscle memory. After finishing, block both:

1. Soak in cool water for 15 minutes.
2. Roll in a towel, then pin flat to shape. Make sure corners are square.
3. Let dry completely.

Styling Your New Placemats

Place them across from each other at the table for a balanced look. The waffle texture faces up. Set a simple plate, a folded napkin, and a glass on each one. Even an everyday meal feels elevated on a handmade placemat. If you only have two, place them at the two seats you use most.

Weekend 2 Completion Checklist

- ☐ Waffle stitch practiced and understood (front post / back post)
- ☐ 2 placemats crocheted with sc border and ends woven in
- ☐ Both placemats blocked, squared, and dried
- ☐ Placemats placed on the dining or kitchen table
- ☐ Leftover yarn stored (you may want to make more placemats later)

Weekend 3: The Living Room — Cushion Cover

Difficulty: Intermediate | Time: 5–6 hours | Makes: 1 cushion cover (45×45cm, fits standard insert)

SATURDAY

Crochet the front panel

SUNDAY

Crochet the back panel, seam, insert cushion

Stepping Up

This weekend introduces two new skills: working a larger flat panel with consistent tension, and seaming two panels together. The seed stitch (also called lemon peel or moss stitch) creates a dense, squishy fabric with a subtle texture that looks far more sophisticated than it is to make.

Materials for This Weekend

- 3–4 skeins worsted acrylic-cotton blend — Color C (each panel uses about 80–90g)
- 5.0mm hook
- Tapestry needle, scissors, stitch markers
- 1 cushion insert, 45×45cm

Seed Stitch Cushion Cover Pattern

Finished size: each panel approximately 45×45cm. The cover should be 1–2cm smaller than the insert for a plump, professional look.

Gauge: 15 sts × 14 rows = 10cm in seed stitch with 5.0mm hook.

Stitch used: Seed stitch = alternating sc and dc in the same row, offset on the next row.

FRONT PANEL

Foundation: Ch 68 (should measure approximately 45cm; adjust if your gauge differs — use an even number of chains).

Row 1: Sc in 2nd ch from hook, *dc in next ch, sc in next ch* — repeat across, ending with dc in the last ch. Turn. (67 sts)

Row 2: Ch 1, sc in first st (the dc), *dc in next st (the sc), sc in next st (the dc)* — repeat across. Turn. (67 sts)

Repeat Row 2 until the panel measures 45cm (approximately 63 rows). The key to seed stitch: always work sc into the top of a dc, and dc into the top of an sc. The stitches offset naturally.

Fasten off. Weave in ends.

BACK PANEL

Make an identical panel. Same foundation chain, same stitch, same measurements.

ASSEMBLY

1. Place both panels together, wrong sides facing out (so the seam will be hidden when you turn it right-side out).
2. Using a tapestry needle and matching yarn, whip stitch around three sides. Work through both loops of each stitch on both panels. Keep the stitches even and snug, about 1 stitch per cm.
3. Turn the cover right-side out through the open side.
4. Insert the cushion form. It should be a snug fit — push all four corners in firmly.
5. Whip stitch the opening closed from the right side, using small, tight stitches that blend into the fabric.

Alternative (removable cover): Instead of stitching the fourth side closed, sew 3–4 simple button loops along one edge and attach matching buttons to the other. This lets you remove the insert for washing.

Common Mistakes at This Stage

- **Panels different sizes:** Measure both panels before seaming. If one is larger, gently block it to match. Even a 1cm difference will show.
- **Loose seaming:** A loose seam lets the insert bulge through. Keep your whip stitches firm and evenly spaced.
- **Forgetting to offset the stitch pattern:** If your seed stitch looks like ribbing instead of a bumpy texture, you are putting sc over sc. Always alternate: sc into dc, dc into sc.
- **Wrong side confusion:** Mark the right side of each panel with a stitch marker before you start seaming. The right side of seed stitch looks slightly smoother.
- **Insert too small:** A 43cm insert in a 45cm cover will look deflated. Match sizes, or go 1–2cm larger on the insert for a plump look.

Weekend 3 Completion Checklist

- ☐ Front panel completed (45×45cm in seed stitch)
- ☐ Back panel completed (same size as front)
- ☐ Both panels measured and matched
- ☐ Panels seamed on three sides
- ☐ Cushion insert placed and fourth side closed
- ☐ All ends woven in securely
- ☐ Cushion placed on the sofa — admired from multiple angles

Weekend 4: The Grand Finale — Throw Blanket

Difficulty: Intermediate | Time: 6–8 hours | Makes: 1 lap throw (100×130cm)

SATURDAY

Foundation + build rows (aim for 60–70cm)

SUNDAY

Continue to full length, add border + fringe, block

The Showpiece

This is the project that will make people say "you made that?" A throw blanket draped over a sofa changes the entire character of a room. We are using moss stitch (also called granite stitch or linen stitch), which creates a beautifully woven-looking fabric that is dense enough to be warm but light enough to drape well. Bulky yarn on a 6.5mm hook means the rows build fast.

Materials for This Weekend

- 6 skeins bulky weight yarn — Color D (approximately 560–600g total)
- 6.5mm hook
- Tapestry needle, scissors, stitch markers
- Blocking mat and pins (or large towels and a flat surface)

Moss Stitch Throw Pattern

Finished size: approximately 100×130cm (39×51") before border.

Gauge: 12 sts × 14 rows = 10cm in moss stitch with 6.5mm hook and bulky yarn.

Stitch used: Moss stitch = ch-1, sc, skip 1 — creates a woven-look fabric.

FOUNDATION

Ch 122 (should measure approximately 100cm; adjust using an even number of chains + 2).

INSTRUCTIONS

Row 1: Sc in 4th ch from hook (the skipped chains count as ch-1 + sk-1), *ch 1, skip 1 ch, sc in next ch* — repeat across. Turn. *(60 sc + 60 ch-1 spaces)*

Row 2: Ch 2, skip first sc, *sc in next ch-1 space, ch 1, skip next sc* — repeat across, ending with sc in the turning chain space. Turn.

Repeat Row 2 until the throw measures 130cm (approximately 182 rows). The rhythm is simple: sc into every ch-1 space, ch 1 over every sc. The pattern offsets itself automatically.

Fasten off. Do not weave in ends yet.

BORDER

Round 1: Join yarn at any corner. Ch 1, sc evenly around the entire throw: sc in each stitch across the top, 3 sc in the corner, sc down the side (approximately 1 sc per row-end — test a few inches and count to keep it even), 3 sc in the corner, sc across the bottom, 3 sc in the corner, sc up the other side, 3 sc in the last corner. Sl st to join.

Round 2: Ch 1, sc in each st around, working 3 sc in each corner stitch. Sl st to join. Fasten off.

The double-round border gives the throw a clean, finished edge and keeps it from curling.

OPTIONAL FRINGE

For a boho or farmhouse look, add fringe to the two short ends:

1. Cut lengths of yarn, each 25cm long. You need 2 strands per fringe cluster, spaced every 2 stitches — approximately 60 clusters per short end (120 clusters total = 240 strands).
2. Fold 2 strands in half. Using your hook, pull the fold through a stitch on the edge, then pull the cut ends through the loop. Tighten firmly.
3. Repeat every 2 stitches across both short ends.
4. Trim fringe to an even length (approximately 10cm finished).

Saturday: Build the Body

The moss stitch is meditative once you find your rhythm. With bulky yarn and a 6.5mm hook, each row takes about 2–3 minutes. Aim for 90–100 rows on Saturday (about 60–70cm). Place a stitch marker every 20 rows so you can track progress without counting. Take a 10-minute break every 45 minutes — your wrists will thank you.

Sunday: Finish, Border & Block

Complete the remaining rows to 130cm. Add the border, then the fringe if you chose it. Then block:

1. This piece is too large for most basins. Soak it in the bathtub in cool water for 20 minutes.
2. Drain, press gently (do not wring), and roll in large bath towels to remove moisture.
3. Lay flat on a clean floor or bed. Pin the corners to shape and straighten the edges. Let dry completely (may take 12–24 hours depending on yarn and humidity — a fan helps).

You Did It

Four weekends ago, you had never crocheted a home decor item. Now you have a handmade throw blanket on your sofa, a cushion cover, placemats on your table, and coasters on your coffee table. Your home is visibly, tangibly different — and you made it all yourself. That is a genuine accomplishment. Drape the throw, step back, and take it in.

Weekend 4 Completion Checklist

- ☐ Throw body crocheted to 100×130cm in moss stitch
- ☐ 2-round sc border completed
- ☐ Fringe added (if desired) and trimmed evenly
- ☐ All ends woven in securely
- ☐ Throw blocked and dried completely
- ☐ Throw draped on the sofa or folded at the foot of the bed
- ☐ Photographed your work — you earned it

BEYOND

What's Next: Beyond 4 Weekends

Your skills are real now — here is where to take them

You have finished four projects, learned half a dozen stitches, and developed the muscle memory that makes crochet feel natural. The question now is not "can I do this?" but "what do I want to make next?"

Your Skill Progression

Here is what you have learned across the four weekends and what each skill unlocks:

SKILL LEARNED	WEEKEND	WHAT IT UNLOCKS NEXT
Working in the round (magic ring, sc increases)	1	Baskets, bowls, round rugs, amigurumi
Working in rows (turning, consistent edges)	2	Scarves, table runners, rectangular blankets
Post stitches (fpdc, bpdc, waffle stitch)	2	Cables, ribbing, textured garments
Alternating stitch patterns (seed stitch)	3	Complex texture patterns, colorwork prep
Seaming and assembly	3	Garments, bags, multi-panel blankets
Large-scale projects (tension over many rows)	4	Full-size blankets, bedspreads, curtains
Borders and finishing	4	Polished, professional-looking edges on any project
Blocking	1, 4	Lace work, garments that need precise fit

Suggested Next Projects

From the main Crochet for Your Home collection, these projects build directly on what you know:

STORAGE BASKETS (SET OF 3)

Builds on: Weekend 1 (rounds), Weekend 4 (working with heavier yarn)

New skill: Working in a continuous spiral (no joining), stiffening with starch or interfacing.

Time: One weekend

TABLE RUNNER

Builds on: Weekend 2 (rows, post stitches)

New skill: Longer repeat patterns, optional tassels at both ends.

Time: One weekend

FULL-SIZE BLANKET

Builds on: Weekend 4 (everything)

New skill: Working with multiple colors, managing a heavy project over 2–3 weekends.

Time: 2–3 weekends

CUSHION COVER SET (3 MATCHING)

Builds on: Weekend 3 (seed stitch, seaming)

New skill: Making a cohesive set with slight variations (different textures, same colors).

Time: One weekend for 2 more covers

Maintaining Momentum

- 1 Start your next project within 7 days.** The longer you wait, the harder it is to pick up the hook again. Even 20 minutes of crocheting keeps the habit alive.
- 2 Keep a project bag ready.** A tote with your current project, hook, scissors, and a few stitch markers by the sofa. If it is out and visible, you will pick it up during TV time.
- 3 Set a "Weekend 5" date.** Block the time on your calendar now, while the momentum is fresh. Choose your next project today and order the yarn this week.
- 4 Photograph and celebrate each finished piece.** Place it in your home, take a photo, and recognize the work. Every finished item is proof that you can do this.
- 5 Revisit the Interior Decoration Guide.** Now that you have four finished pieces, look at Section 6 (Creating a Cohesive Home) and plan what your home needs next.

Next Step

You have completed the 4-Weekend Program. You own four handmade pieces that did not exist a month ago, and every one of them is in your home, being used, being admired.

Pick your next project from the main collection, set a date, and keep building.

The patterns, the skills, and the confidence are yours now. Use them.